

If the specified temporary speed limit is lower for site workplace safety requirements than traffic safety requirements, the temporary speed limit for workplace safety requirements takes precedence (e.g. high level of hazard for workers on foot in a worksite with reduced visibility – the required temporary speed limit is 40km/h or less).

Temporary speed zone conditions and lengths are outlined in Table 5.5.

The primary objective of temporary speed zones is to ensure that all workers operating in and around the work zone are safe. The secondary objective is to ensure the application of temporary speed zones are safe and convenient for road users. Sufficient warning of changes in speed limit due to surface condition and work zone layouts need to be communicated to all road users.

Where a decision has been made to create a temporary speed limit, the following apply:

- The temporary speed limit should be self-enforcing or will be enforced.
- The temporary speed limit must be realistic and reflect the condition of the worksite in real time. This will reduce the risk of road users ignoring the speed limit.
- The temporary speed limit must be obvious to all road users.
- The temporary speed limit should encourage uniform speed of travel.
- Speeds should be low enough to allow road users time to react to signs, directions, traffic control or unusual events.
- The temporary speed limit must not be so low that a significant number of road users disregard it.
- Temporary speed limits may be a compromise where conditions vary over a length of road.
- The length of the temporary speed zone should be as shown in Table 5.5.
- The speed limit applied to the zone must not exceed the maximum safe speed of travel at which traffic can safely traverse the site. The maximum safe speed of travel depends on a number of factors including:
 - number and type of vehicles
 - number of pedestrians / cyclists
 - type of works undertaken
 - extent of the works